RESEARCH IN SCIENCE
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Undergraduates talk about their choice to study physics at university: what was key to their participation?

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WHAT DID THIS PAPER CONTRIBUTE?

- Rodd, Reiss and Mujtaba analysed narrative interviews with seven first-year physics undergraduates.
- In all seven interviews, the authors identified a significant adult, often a teacher or family member.
- They found no evidence that outreach projects or competitions had been key to choosing physics.

Rodd et al. (2013) · Research in Science & Technological Education · doi.org/10.1080/02635143.2013.811072

WHAT HAS CHANGED, AND WHY IT MATTERS

- Relationships with significant people, more than particular activities, appeared central to students' pathways into physics.
- Thirteen years on, it asks how teachers, families and other influential figures shape young people's physics identities.
- Today, mentors and online voices may join teachers and families among those figures.

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